COUNTRY REPORTS: MOZAMBIQUE

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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Mozambique's standing national ICT policy dates from 2000 and still carries the state's commitments on broadband, cybersecurity, data centres and cloud, data protection, digital identification, digital payments, digital signatures and universal access. Drafting of a National Digital Transformation Strategy began in February 2026, and none has been adopted.

What has been adopted since is sectoral. The 2018 Information Society Policy carries broadband and universal access; a National Cybersecurity Policy and Strategy was gazetted in 2021 and is now being revised into a 2026–2030 strategy; the National Financial Inclusion Strategy 2025–2031 launched in August 2025; and the Intellectual Property Policy and Strategy 2026–2035, approved as Resolution No. 53/2026 of 30 June 2026, orders a study of AI's effect on the patent framework, with legal and institutional modernisation its largest costed component at 719.6 million meticais.

The most consequential paper is not yet a policy at all. INTIC's second zero draft of a National Data Governance Policy, circulated in November 2025, would create a National Data Governance Council able to compel testimony and documents, run unannounced inspections, seize evidence, freeze data processing pending investigation, levy graded civil fines and maintain a public register of those named, paired with written notice, access to the evidence, a hearing, and internal and judicial review. It is drafted as a Council of Ministers Resolution whose number and approval date are still placeholders, and it would seat that council alongside a national data protection authority Mozambican law has not established.

President Chapo ordered an overhaul of digital government at the country's first national digital-transformation conference in February 2026, and delivery sits with the Ministry of Communications and Digital Transformation, which provides the technical support for the Portal do Cidadão and has created a dedicated agency to coordinate the digitisation programme. On infrastructure the government's stated position is that investment is the private sector's responsibility and its own role is confined to policy and regulation.

The plan meant to turn the president's order into delivery is not adopted either. The Digital Transformation Operational Plan 2026–2029 was under appraisal at the technical commission's second session on 21 September 2026, to be harmonised and costed within two to three months, naming an interoperability portal, a payments platform for state services, a government cloud and a government data centre. The commission is a multisectoral technical body created by decree on 10 March 2026. A civil-society review of September 2026 treats the Strategic Plan for the Information Society 2019–2028, approved as Resolution 52/2019, as the operative national strategy

and finds its execution hampered by limited consolidated public reporting and dependence on donor cycles. A proposed Internet for All strategy with targets to 2030 was presented in Maputo, where only 15% of the population was said to afford mobile data (2026).

Legislation and regulation

Mozambique's Constitutional Council struck down the government's telecommunications blocking power on 29 July 2026 on who may legislate rather than on what the power did: the executive had legislated in a field reserved to the Assembly of the Republic, which the Council held the most serious defect and therefore did not examine the other alleged violations, and restrictions on those rights may be imposed only by legislation the Assembly approves. Decree 48/2025 of 16 December had approved the traffic-control regulation and revoked its 2023 predecessor; the provisions under it that allowed communications to be blocked were among those declared unconstitutional. The communications minister accepted the ruling on 3 August 2026; the day after, the Council of Ministers spokesman said the executive would pursue the same end by a route that does not contradict the Council, and no bill, instrument or timetable has been named for it.

Four statutes bearing on the digital estate reached the gazette in 2026. The Cyber Security Law (13/2026) and the Cybercrime Law (14/2026) were published on 1 July 2026 and came into force ninety days later, on 29 September 2026. The cyber law finances a Cyber Security Fund from a flat 1 per cent of the prior year's gross revenue of the firms licensed to provide cybersecurity services while leaving the fund's operating rules to a regulation that has not been made. The National Payments System Law followed as Lei n.º 15/2026 of 2 July 2026, replacing a regime in place since 2008. Decrees 71/2025 and 72/2025 of 31 December 2025 brought data centres and cloud services under licence, with provisions on data centres located abroad, a 90-day vacatio legis and one year for operating data centres to comply.

The fourth is the Press and Media Law, Law 3/2026, gazetted on 26 May 2026, which brings online-only publications inside the media framework and caps foreign capital in a media organisation at 35 per cent. Below statute, Decree 36/2026 on telecommunications and scarce-resource licensing was published by the regulator on 21 August 2026, and the Council of Ministers approved a Postal Security Regulation on 15 September 2026, with controls against fraud and cyber threats as e-commerce parcels grow. Two texts are in drafting and neither is published: a law on artificial intelligence in education, which the minister said in September 2026 would reach the Council of Ministers before the end of the year, and a Labour Law revision to cover work done through digital platforms.

Subscriber registration is the older layer's one recent replacement: Decree 13/2023 revoked the 2015 regulation and requires operators to validate every subscriber and device against the regulator's registration database and a risk centre before activating it. The holes sit elsewhere in that layer. Digital identity rests on several instruments rather than one law, and there is no digital-identity-specific statute. Decree 67/2017 frames data sharing between public bodies and between public and private ones, but no comprehensive cross-government data-sharing law exists. The regulation setting the interoperability framework for digital government systems is in its final phase of revision. The personal data protection law is still a draft.

Data protection

Mozambique has no personal data protection law and no authority to enforce one, and the money to build the authority is being cut: the World Bank's digital acceleration project proposed in June 2025 to cut its data governance, data protection, cloud readiness and cybersecurity subcomponent from US$18 million to US$8 million as one that had advanced slowly, with the Data Protection Office stalled until the law is adopted. The project's indicator for regulations adopted on data protection stood at 0 against a target of 2 (March 2026). A draft law went

to public consultation in September 2025 and has not been passed by the Assembleia da República; parliament's standing commission placed it on the agenda of the ordinary session opening on 28 October 2026, and establishment of the Data Protection Office is stalled pending its adoption.

Protection is scattered instead across article 71 of the Constitution, the Electronic Transactions Law of 2017, article 189 of the Law on Credit Institutions and article 8 of the Labour Law, with the Electronic Transactions Law requiring notification to INTIC before personal data is processed and consent before it is transferred. Decree 73/2025, in force since 1 March 2026, gives consumers of postal and telecoms services rights of access, objection, rectification and erasure over the personal data operators hold; it reaches one sector's customers only. There is no general mandatory breach notification requirement and no way for a person to see online what the national identity database holds about them. INTIC holds some data-protection competencies without being an authority, and the draft law would designate it the national one; by February 2026 it had launched a pilot platform for reporting personal-data breaches, running a notification channel with no statute behind it.

The draft was still under public discussion in September 2026: a media institute told a Maputo round table on 3 September that the law must not become a barrier to press freedom and the right to information, and INTIC's board chair said approval would be only the start of building supervision and accountability. In the same week INTIC set out a registration and licensing regime for digital platforms and intermediary service providers, foreign operators included, under which applicants are to declare where data are stored.

The sharpest test came from the courts. Decree 48/2025 let INCM, by court order, instruct the partial or total blocking of telecommunications on an imminent risk to public security, made by executive decree a year after the network blackouts that followed the October 2024 elections. The Constitutional Council found on 29 July 2026 that it established a regime of monitoring, data collection, suspension of services and intervention in networks that substantially restricted freedom of expression and information and the privacy and inviolability of communications, and that the Telecommunications Act relied on as its legal base authorises no structural and permanent surveillance. The review reached it at the request of the Provedor de Justiça, prompted by the Centre for Democracy and Human Rights.

Regional collaboration

Mozambique's ATDI and Ethiopia's FaydaVerse Digital Solutions Enterprise signed a memorandum of understanding in Addis Ababa on 27 April 2026 covering digital identity and public infrastructure, open standards, interoperability and capacity-building. Mozambique has ratified the African Union's Malabo Convention on cyber security and personal data protection, and the president has named Kenya and Rwanda as the models for the digital government overhaul he ordered. Its only regional economic community membership is SADC, and it scores 57.6 out of 100 on the Ibrahim Index's Regional Integration measure, 14th of 54 African states and down 0.9 points over the decade (2023).

In August 2026 the customs administrations of Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe adopted a roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange in Pretoria, phased from priority corridors.

The ICT institute joined TriDigital, reported 9 October 2026: a common framework and bilingual platform for assessing the digital maturity of public institutions in Angola, Guinea-Bissau, Mozambique and São Tomé and Príncipe, running to January 2028 and including a demonstration diagnostic of the country's own maturity.

Standards

Mozambique has a government interoperability framework, but it is only partially used across government, and the regulation that would set it is in its final phase of revision. The published standards that do bind sit in one corner of the estate: Decreto n.º 82/2020 vests management of the .mz domain and its official subdomains in INTIC and requires registrant data published through WHOIS to be accurate, complete and current, gives registrants rights of access, updating and rectification, and obliges the registry regulator to define and publish its own personal-data management policy. The government operates no open-source software programme (2025), and the national standards institute is an ISO correspondent member rather than a full member body.

The one service-quality series published is the communications regulator's: 391,723 consumer complaints were recorded in 2025, up 44% on 2024, with a 95.2% resolution rate on the telecommunications ones, the regulator attributing much of the rise to better recording. On 5 September 2026 the prime minister directed that INTIC's digital certification system be extended across all state sectors.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

A civil-society petition unwound the government's internet-blocking decree in six months: the Centre for Democracy and Human Rights petitioned the Provedor de Justiça on 29 January 2026, the Ombudsman put the question to the Constitutional Council on 17 February, and judgment came at the end of July 2026. It ran through an ombudsman rather than a consultation, and the assessment that found no online citizen participation or e-consultation platform and no online feedback or grievance redress mechanism (2025) has since been overtaken in part. Consultation is now happening off-platform and in large numbers: the Presidency opened the national and diaspora consultation phase of an Inclusive National Dialogue in September 2025, with a technical commission including civil-society members and ten working groups drawing partly on citizens who answered a public call, and the social security institute ran a nationwide consultation across all provinces in March 2026 on revising the compulsory social security regulation. Neither is a standing platform, and no submission count or published outcome exists for either.

Mozambique has a right to information law in force.

The space in which digital policy can be contested has been narrowing. Over 2014–2023 Freedom of Association and Assembly fell 12.5 points to 37.5 out of 100, Civil Society Space fell 6.4 points to 55.1, and Deliberative and Participatory Governance fell 5.5 points to 52.9; Freedom of Expression and Belief fell 19.4 points to 62.3, 25th of 54 African states; and Media Freedom stands at 50.1, 34th of 54 (2023). The communications regulator suspended two radio stations in Nampula city, Vida and Encontro, for 48 hours in February 2025.

When the telecommunications regulations were challenged, the communications minister publicly rejected the suggestion that they were an attempt to restrict internet use (March 2026).

Finance

Financial sustainability

Mozambique's 2026 budget puts the whole investment budget of its digital ministry on external money: the final 2026 budget maps give the Ministry of Communications and Digital Transformation MZN 2.64 billion of externally financed investment and nothing from internal funds (FY2026).

The domestic-state share of the digital lines of the 2026 budget is 40.0% at the appropriated stage, down from 62.3% in 2025 (FY2026).

What keeps the systems in service is the state's own. The 2025 budget carried MZN 1.83 billion for producing passports and other identity and travel documents, MZN 133.8 million for identity cards and MZN 55.0 million for leased circuits serving the identification and migration services, all from internal funds (FY2025), and the 2026 operating line of CEDSIF, the finance ministry's systems centre, is MZN 657.8 million, 89.2% of it salaries (FY2026).

Voting the money has not meant spending it. The General State Account for 2025 records the MZN 500 million domestic public-services modernisation project reduced to nothing in-year and unspent, the revitalisation of the government data centre executed at MZN 25.5 million of MZN 30 million voted, and the externally financed strengthening of INTIC's certification and PKI services executed at MZN 5.1 million against a revised MZN 3.03 billion (FY2025).

The external money has closing dates. The World Bank's EDGE grant closes on 28 February 2027, and the Digital Acceleration Project closes on 31 July 2028 and, as agreed with the government in January 2026, keeps operating outside the national e-SISTAFE financial management system on parallel arrangements.

What the state has in law is a levy on the operators: the universal-access fund, a separate patrimony run by the communications regulator, takes 1% of licensed operators' prior-year gross revenue under Decree 11/2025, and a licensing regulation in force since August 2026 lets the regulator convert operators' fines into universal-service obligations. The plan meant to pay for the rest had no price as at September 2026: the digital transformation commission expected to cost the 2026–2029 operational plan within two to three months, with financing spread across many separately funded projects.

MoUs and other agreements

The largest sum reached by memorandum rather than by contract is American: about US$83 million for health data systems over 2026–2030 under the America First Global Health Strategy, in a memorandum that declares itself not an international agreement, makes the money subject to the availability of funds, and reserves the United States the right to revisit its funding levels if no mutually acceptable technology roadmap is agreed. That is money planned rather than money moving.

The other signature carries no money at all: ATDI and Ethiopia's FaydaVerse Digital Solutions Enterprise signed a memorandum in Addis Ababa on digital identity and public infrastructure in April 2026, covering open standards, interoperability and capacity-building. The Ministry of Economy was also exploring a partnership with SpaceX on connectivity and digital infrastructure (July 2026), with nothing signed. In September 2026 the finance ministry and Brazil's public services management ministry signed a memorandum on exchanging experience and training staff in procurement, payroll management and digital transformation, with no value or deliverable published.

New investments

The World Bank's flagship digital operation had disbursed 36 per cent overall but only 14 per cent against its digital components, with procurement unlaunched on eleven approved activities and implementation downgraded to Moderately Unsatisfactory at mid-term (June 2025). The same review proposed raising its rural connectivity allocation from US$42.5 million to US$58 million, funded by cuts to data governance, cybersecurity and digital inclusion, not by new money.

Nineteen external digital-sector commitments are on the record, announced between 2015 and 2026, running to 2030 (October 2026). Those with a recorded value come to just over US$1 billion, most of it lending rather than grant aid and most of it for connectivity rather than digital government, identity or health systems. The World Bank carries just over half on four operations, China Eximbank the next largest share on two loans to the state operator. More than a quarter of the total is on commitments not confirmed as moving.

The largest single live commitment is the World Bank's Sustainable Energy and Broadband Access in Rural Mozambique Project, US$343 million over 2021–2027, rural broadband laid alongside rural electrification on shared infrastructure; the finance table counts half of it as digital. Its Digital Governance and Economy Project was approved in 2021 as an IDA grant of SDR 105 million, US$150 million equivalent, running to 2027, and the Digital Acceleration Project runs 2022–2028 on an IDA credit of SDR 148.8 million, US$200 million equivalent at appraisal (June 2022).

China Eximbank finances the state operator Tmcel, lending for a first phase of national mobile network modernisation (2020), with a further US$200 million facility for a second phase reported secured in 2025.

The European Union funds VaMOZ Digital!, a EUR 22.5 million grant over 2022–2029. The ITU carries that programme's regulatory component on CHF 2,244,820 over 2023–2027. In June 2026 the EU signed a further EUR 28 million for digital transformation under Global Gateway, with women's participation in the digital economy its stated focus.

Canada's two UNICEF-channelled phases for civil registration and vital statistics, CAD 19.5 million from 2017 and CAD 6.5 million from 2021, both closed in 2023.

The newest and smallest is Korean: ICT equipment valued at more than US$300,000, financed by KOICA and delivered through UNDP, was handed to the disaster risk management institute on 9 September 2026.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Mobile service reached all but six of Mozambique's 453 administrative posts in 2024, down from eleven a year earlier; on the regulator's finer unit, 1,013 of 1,222 localities had service in 2024, leaving 209 with none, with about 84 per cent of the population within reach of a 4G signal that year.

Reach is not use. 20.5 per cent of individuals used the internet in 2024, and mobile connections were equivalent to 55 per cent of the population, against 17.1 million mobile voice subscriptions on INCM's own count for the same year. Price is not the constraint either: a gigabyte of mobile data cost under a dollar in 2023. The IIAG's Internet & Computers indicator put Mozambique at 18.8 out of 100 in 2023, 45th of 54 African states and unmoved over the decade, while Mobile Communications rose 12.8 points to 62.5 — the network improved and the terms of access did not.

INCM awarded 5G and 4G licences to all three operators on 23 June 2026, after opening bids by administrative consignment in the 700 MHz, 2.6 GHz and 3.5 GHz bands that April. The remaining coverage gap is broken down operator by operator, with state-owned Tmcel furthest behind (2024).

The Constitutional Council struck down on 29 July 2026 the executive decree that had let INCM, by court order, instruct partial or total blocking of telecommunications; the government, saying it respects the ruling, is looking for another route to the same end.

Public money is aimed at the rural gap: the World Bank's digital acceleration project carries a US$50 million rural tower investment due for completion in April 2027 and US$11.5 million for MoRENet bandwidth to universities and technical institutions (June 2025), while infrastructure financed by the universal-access fund is State property held by the operating carrier in usufruct and subject to mandatory roaming. MOZIX, the only internet exchange point, runs in Maputo with around 19 peering members and peak traffic above 150 Gbps (2025).

The state operator is partly for sale. The finance and communications ministries invited expressions of interest in September 2026 from strategic partners for Tmcel, including a possible partial sale of the state's shares, under a resolution of 21 August 2026; its documentation for bidders counts 1.79 million active mobile customers at the end of 2025 on 1,303 sites, 724 of them carrying 4G and 447 of those in the south against 120 in the north. The 5G licences carry a June 2027 deadline for service in every provincial capital, and the regulator is building a tariff management system, to operate from November 2026, after complaints that data bundles run out before their stated expiry. The regulator validated the national Internet para Todos strategy, which targets 95% broadband coverage and at least 60% of schools connected by 2030, alongside 2030 targets for internet use, digital skills and public access points (2026).

Data Storage

Mozambique operates no government cloud, and has no government cloud policy in place (2025). The state's own data centre at Maluana is technically capable but under-used, and the regulator's own site carries the case that without national digitisation and systems-integration strategies it has not drawn government institutions to put their data in it (July 2025).

Commercial capacity sits almost entirely in the capital. Maputo held at least seven commercial facilities in 2025 — a carrier-neutral Digital Realty site, NTT, SEACOM, PCCW Global and Teledata alongside Vodacom's Tier III building — Vodacom opened a further data centre in March 2025, and BCX launched Alibaba Cloud's Africa local public cloud from the city in 2024. Universidade Eduardo Mondlane inaugurated a data centre on 3 August 2026, with roughly fourteen times the storage of the server room it replaces, and it is meant to help secure the `.mz` domain and the MozIX exchange. INTIC's AI study records a recommendation for at least one data centre in each of the Centro and Norte zones (May 2025).

The rules on where that data may sit were enacted at the end of 2025, subject to a 90-day vacatio legis, with provisions on data centres located abroad. The consultation drafts behind them would confine classified information to private clouds on national territory absent express authorisation from the regulator, require the data of essential services to be held in-country, sort facilities into four resilience categories, and impose a 500-metre setback, 90 days of CCTV retention and mandatory civil-liability insurance on operators. The financial sector has its own rule: Banco de Moçambique's Aviso 6/GBM/2026, gazetted on 31 August 2026 and in force 60 days later, revokes the 2003 notice and requires every bank and financial company to keep its primary data centre and principal information systems in Mozambique, with secondary centres abroad only on the central bank's authorisation.

The state is regulating a hosting layer it does not yet have. The communications minister has conceded that national compute, data centres included, cannot support more advanced AI models (July 2026), and the government's position is that building it, including the proposed regional AI data centre, is the private sector's responsibility (August 2026).

Energy

Mozambique's off-grid electrification framework scores highly on the World Bank's RISE indicators and the rural energy fund FUNAE runs around 76 mini-grids totalling about 6MW (2021).

36 per cent of Mozambique's population had access to electricity in 2023, and access to energy is among the country's ten worst-scoring IIAG indicators, at 17.2 out of 100 and 42nd of 54 African states in 2023 despite gaining 4.6 points since 2014. The shortfall falls where most people live: urban access stood at 76 per cent against 15 per cent in rural areas in 2022, a gap of 61 percentage points. What supply there is rests on one source — hydropower generates 83 per cent of electricity, gas 15 per cent (2024) — and drought, cyclone damage and infrastructure vandalism during civil unrest strained the state utility EDM's ability to maintain supply through 2025.

Operators are building around the grid rather than waiting on it. The university data centre opened in August 2026 was built with integrated solar generation alongside grid and generator supply, and strengthening energy infrastructure is one of the five priorities the government names for its artificial-intelligence ambition (August 2026).

Technical Capacity

INTIC, the institute holding Mozambique's cybersecurity and data-governance mandate, was appropriated MZN 73,636,370 for 2026, of which MZN 57,064,340 is personnel and MZN 16,423,800 goods and services, with no row at all in the investment tables — a payroll rather than a budget to build with.

The administration around it reads better on paper than in delivery. Public Administration is Mozambique's best-ranked IIAG sub-category, at 62.6 out of 100 and 12th of 54 African states in 2023, a standing that rests on civil registration, tax mobilisation and statistical capacity rather than on service delivery; Effective Administration, which measures the professionalism and functioning of the civil service, sits at 45.3 and 35th of 54 and is slightly down on 2014, and Budgetary & Financial Management fell 20.8 points over the decade to 61.1, the third most deteriorated of the country's 96 indicators.

Execution is where that shows. The World Bank's mid-term review of the digital acceleration project found procurement unlaunched on approved activities and downgraded implementation progress (June 2025).

Specialist depth exists but is countable: fourteen Mozambican specialists hold Open CSIRT Foundation SIM3 certification, the instrument by which a response team's maturity is assessed (July 2026), alongside donor-funded cybersecurity training for INTIC technicians and the wider professional base and a digital skills strategy and civil-servant training programme pitched at basic skills (2025).

The systems the state depends on are still run with outside hands. The national identity and travel-document system is built, distributed and supported under an eight-year public-private concession, with the supplier keeping a permanent Maputo office and government staff trained to operate it, and in January 2026 the government was tendering for outside services to strengthen civil registration and identification.

Cybersecurity

Mozambique ranked first among Portuguese-speaking African states on the ITU's 2024 Global Cybersecurity Index, improving on its 2020 result, while the money behind the work moved the other way: the digital acceleration project's proposed restructuring would cut its data governance and cybersecurity allocation from US$18 million to US$8 million, and digital inclusion from US$40 million to US$28 million (June 2025).

The institution is statutory before it is operational. Law 13/2026 formally creates the national cyber incident response team and seats its operation inside INTIC, but the Cyber Security Law and the companion Cybercrime Law, published on 1 July 2026, came into force only on 29 September 2026, with their implementing regulations due within 180 days of publication. The project's own CSIRT-improvement target has been met while its data-protection regulation target has registered no movement (March 2026).

Duties are arriving sector by sector rather than across the estate. Notice 2/GBM/2026 requires every financial institution to connect to the Single Payments Network and to report any payment outage lasting more than ten minutes to the Banco de Moçambique within sixty minutes, and regulations on cloud computing and radio centres approved alongside the two cyber statutes are mandatory for operators of critical infrastructure (July 2026). Across the estate as a whole there is no general mandatory data breach notification requirement (2024), though INTIC had launched a pilot platform for reporting personal-data breaches by February 2026 — a channel running ahead of the statute that would oblige anyone to use it.

Nor has the state's largest personal-data holding been tested in public: no independent security audit, penetration test or vulnerability assessment of the national identity system has been published (2023). The 2021 cybersecurity policy is under revision into a national strategy for 2026–2030 that has not been adopted (July 2026).

The minister said on 7 October 2026 that a national network of response teams now has teams in government, the cyber defence unit, the research network, the regulator, the telecoms sector and four provinces, with more being set up.

DPI

Data Exchange

The World Bank and African Development Bank's data-governance diagnostic of December 2025 found data management practices across the public sector fragmented. A government interoperability framework exists but is only partially used across government (2025), and the regulation that would put that framework on a statutory footing was still in the final phase of revision in 2026.

Of fifteen government functions counted in 2025, only civil registration was even partially connected to a national data exchange. Health, passports, digital identity, payments, planning and statistics and revenue were under development; agriculture, justice, employment, driver licensing, social protection, education and business registration had got no further than planned; and the electoral register was connected to nothing at all.

What is being built is an X-Road interoperability platform, under implementation in May 2026. The digital agency said in September 2026 that it expects the platform in the fourth quarter of the year, naming no operator or connected agency. The mobile digital identity and electronic signature infrastructure tendered in May 2026 is specified to run over that exchange and to connect to the DNIC population register. The constraint is the key itself: the Unique Citizen Identification Number is assigned automatically only to children born since 2017, so an interoperability diagnostic of the social protection, civil registration and tax systems proposed a composite identifier drawing on the identity card, citizen and taxpayer numbers (2021).

Live exchange, as opposed to planned exchange, is a handful of pilots. Since July 2024 e-SIRCEV has exchanged birth data in real time with the hospital data management module, launched in Inhambane province, where facilities using the e-SIRCEV birth module were to grow from five to nineteen. A disease-specific laboratory platform carries HIV viral-load results electronically to health facilities instead of on paper (2025). And e-INAS, the social protection beneficiary system, was linked only to the payment providers M-Pesa, eMola and Paycode (2021). The digital transformation agency trained 25 technicians from nine public bodies on the X-Road data-exchange layer, led by Estonian experts (2026).

Digital Identity and CRVS

DNIC produced 856,101 national identity cards in the first half of 2026, 297,470 of them issued free of charge under the World Bank-funded EDGE project. Free first issuance has been in force nationwide since 13 November 2023 and was extended in July 2026 to 2027 and widened from the identity card to the birth certificate and the cédula pessoal, for adults as well as children. Coverage nonetheless remains far short of the population (2024).

Donor money carried better than a third of the country's identity-card output in the first half of 2026: the free EDGE-funded cards were 34.7% of all cards produced.

Civil registration is the weaker half. Roughly a third of children under five had their births registered (2023), a position the government itself calls a critical deficit and the reason for the free birth-registration campaign running from 23 March to 31 December 2026 and aimed at around seven million unregistered people. The electronic register behind it, e-SIRCEV, has run since March 2019 in 121 of Mozambique's 164 civil registries, assigning the Unique Citizen Identification Number at birth (2021). The two services have met at the counter: a campaign launched at Nacala in March 2025 registered births and issued identity cards on the spot from the registrar's electronic record, aiming at 200,000 people over two months.

The Bilhete de Identidade is the primary legal proof of identity, needed to vote, open a bank account, take formal employment and reach education and health services, but it is a physical biometric credential with no digital authentication function: no online biometric matching, no PIN or one-time password, no QR verification (2023). Closing that is what the May 2026 tender by the digital agency ATDI for a national mobile digital identity and electronic signature infrastructure is for, and the specification asks for something device-agnostic across SIM, eSIM and Java Card.

By September 2026 a consultancy shortlist for that infrastructure had gone to the World Bank, with contracting planned for the month. On registration, the justice sector is installing 100 more civil-registration posts in health units with maternity wards, beside about 250 already operating, so that newborns are registered before leaving hospital.

The system is run under contract, with donor money behind its expansion. Muhlbauer holds an eight-year concession from 2018 to build, distribute and support the identity and travel-document system, keeps a 60-person office in Maputo and has trained around 800 government staff (2024), and the World Bank's US$150 million EDGE grant, appraised in 2021, finances wider legal identity coverage and a unique identification number. No independent security audit, penetration test or vulnerability assessment of the national identity system has been published (2023).

Digital Payments and Fintech

The instant payment rail is live and still small. METIX launched in March 2026 with interbank person-to-person transfers free for individuals and access over USSD, and, operated by SIMO, it was carrying more than 11,000 transfers a day by 30 July 2026, roughly triple its March volume. Participation is mandatory for mobile wallet operators, which makes it a national rail and not a bank-sector product; it was established as a 24/7 retail instant payments mechanism by Notice No. 1/GBM/2026. The market underneath it holds 15 commercial banks, 12 microbanks, three e-money institutions and more than 25 million mobile wallet accounts open in early 2026.

Accounts have outrun use. Electronic money accounts reached 130.9 per 100 adults in the second quarter of 2026, against 33.8 for traditional bank accounts, with 144.7 per 100 men against 118.5 per 100 women. E-money accounts reached the equivalent of 109.8% of the adult population by the first quarter of 2025, up from 28.6% in 2015, while 46% of adults held an active mobile money account in 2024, and access to banking services is among Mozambique's ten worst-scoring governance indicators (2023).

Control of the switch is closely held. The Banco de Moçambique holds the majority of SIMO's shares, appoints its board chairperson, acts as settlement agent and approves its fees, only banks sit on the board, and the scheme rules are available to participants only (2025). The statutory frame was rewritten through 2026, with a new National Payments System law signed into force in June and every financial institution required to connect to the national switch.

Exclusion is written into the rules. Mozambique has no legal framework giving refugees, asylum seekers or migrants a right to open digital payment accounts, and standard know-your-customer checks require a national identity document or a passport (2023). The workaround runs through welfare: social protection beneficiary cards, issued by INAS rather than by the identity system, are accepted by the central bank as an alternative identity document for opening a payment account. Government-to-person disbursement over the switch is a planned next phase rather than active at national scale (2025), though the social action institute had paid over 200,000 of about 800,000 post-emergency beneficiaries through mobile wallets by March 2023, and the largest digital transfer programme on record belongs to a donor: WHO has paid more than US$14.4 million to nearly 246,000 health workers and volunteers by mobile money since 2024. The central bank governor was reported saying the metical could be used for regional payments through the settlement system from January 2027. The central bank licensed a payments aggregator as a payment service provider, among the first such licences, allowing merchants to be onboarded directly across the three mobile money operators.

Registries

The best-covered register in the country is the electoral one: 17.2 million voters were registered for the 2024 general elections, 333,839 of them in the diaspora, on a register the elections commission's technical secretariat STAE produces afresh for each election. Set against it, more than 80% of land held under good-faith or customary occupation is not formally registered (2021), and the World Bank land project closed in March 2024 with 1.28 million land-use rights recorded in the SiGIT land information system, against a target of 2 million, and a 2024 survey of manufacturing micro, small and medium enterprises found roughly half had no state registration of any kind and only around 11% held a taxpayer number — in an economy that is overwhelmingly informal.

The registers that exist are mostly partial. Civil registration runs on e-SIRCEV, operated by the National Directorate of Registries and Notaries; the business register takes online submissions from legal entities through the registries service's user portal; the Revenue Authority's taxpayer register is keyed to the NUIT and covers personal and business taxes alike; social protection beneficiaries sit in INAS's own registration system and the e-INAS platform (2021), with a national social registry still to be established (2025). A national postal addressing code was piloted in Manhiça in 2020, with six cities planned over the following five years. The next register to arrive is a humanitarian one: validation of a beneficiary and humanitarian assistance management system was completed with national launch stated for October 2026, the platform backed by the World Food Programme, under pilot and built to interoperate with the social-support database so duplicate and fictitious beneficiary registrations can be curbed. No data-protection basis, retention rule or enrolment target is published for it.

Where the registers meet, they meet on paper. A NUIT is compulsory before business licensing, which cross-references the tax and business registers procedurally and nothing more, and interoperability between the land information system, municipal cadastres and the Justice Ministry's property registry was still a project goal in 2018. None of them can be reconciled against a full population count while identity-card coverage stays incomplete.

The elections commission is studying Angola's permanent voter registration as an alternative to Mozambique's pre-election model (August 2026), and the disaster management agency INGD has announced a biometric registry of humanitarian aid recipients, piloted in Beira ahead of an October 2026 launch, to stop duplicate assistance.

Sectoral management information systems

The systems that handle money are real; the systems that handle people are not. Mozambique runs custom-built financial management, payroll, tax administration and human resources systems, with customs on commercial off-the-shelf software (2025), and the financial management system reaches both central and sub-national government. Even there the reach is uneven: the treasury system settles through real-time gross settlement but is only partially used by ministries, departments and agencies (2025).

Customs has cleared through the Janela Única Electrónica single window since 2012, which had cut clearance steps from 32 to 8 by 2017. Revenue is where the state performs — Mozambique ranks first of 54 African states on tax and revenue mobilisation (2023) — and education is where it does not. StatEduc, the education management information system, still relies on physical questionnaires and aggregated rather than individual records, with a fully digital real-time entry platform only planned (2025), though Milange district in Zambézia has taken its education data system down to school level since mid-2024, with other districts in Nampula and Zambézia following. The education ministry's technology plan, last updated in 2019, sets out interoperability with other government institutions and student records keyed to the Unique Citizen Identification Number — a programme rather than a system.

Health is split between a paper base and donor-built platforms. Primary health care facilities recorded and reported on paper registers and forms, with 52 monthly reporting forms mandated, the most of five countries studied (2016–17). A memorandum signed with the United States in December 2025 sets commitments to a national health data exchange and a health data warehouse, and provides for a US-built patient tracking system to pass to Mozambican management by June 2026, under a data-sharing agreement signed the same day and not annexed to it.

Elsewhere it is pilots and memoranda. The courts' electronic case system ran in only 21 pilot courts, not fully, in July 2024, with Law 8/2024 on electronic case processing still unregulated, and two climate-informed malaria forecasting pilots on DHIS2 stalled when the climate data feed stopped (2025). A gender-based violence case-data tool was being piloted in four provinces, with nationwide expansion still planned (2023), a KOICA-funded digital road traffic-offence monitoring centre began operating in Greater Maputo in December 2025, and the road transport institute INATRO signed a memorandum with CEDSIF, the finance ministry's shared systems-hosting centre, in August 2025 to host and modernise its driver-licensing and vehicle systems.

The President laid the first stone in August 2024 for a building in Maputo to house the interior ministry's public security management information system, financed with US$11m from Korea's export credit bank and due in December 2025.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Since 3 August 2026 the Tax Authority has been issuing tax clearance certificates requested online through the taxpayer portal, against a stated ten working days — and that is near the frontier of what the Mozambican state lets anyone complete online. The national public service portal is informational only, so a citizen can read about a service but cannot transact through it (2025), and the Portal do Cidadão offered about 26 services to more than 3,000 users in September 2026, ahead of its official launch, with an inventory of public services drawn up for digitisation and passports and driving licences going first.

What does work is concentrated in tax and procurement. The Tax Authority's e-Declaração and taxpayer portal let taxpayers file returns electronically, obtain certificates and check their tax status, and the online tax portal supports registration, filing and payment. E-procurement is in use and publishes both tender notices and awarded contracts, and an electronic procurement system to run the cycle from planning to payment was launched in April 2025 with a new central purchasing body, for phased rollout, a public job portal handles registration, vacancy search and applications, including for public-sector recruitment, and an online social protection portal is in use (2025). For

business, Decree No. 40/2026 routes notification of low-risk activities preferably through the e-BAU platform, treating paper as exceptional and putting kiosks at counters for applicants who cannot use it directly. A new industrial licensing regulation moves applications onto e-BAU, issues licences electronically under a QR code and deems an application approved where the authority misses its deadline, from 8 November 2026.

The newest transactional service is in road transport: since 1 September 2026 applications for special transit licences for oversize and overweight vehicles run end to end online. The government email service was restored on 14 September 2026 after an outage whose start and cause were not given. An integrated centre issuing identity cards, passports, DIRE residence documents, driving licences and residence permits in one place opened in Maputo on 14 October 2026.

None of it knows who the citizen is. No central government portal authenticates users with the national identity card: the e-visa platform and the SIGAV passport-appointment system use ordinary login credentials (2023). Nor is there an open government data portal or a public consultation platform. On grievance channels the assessment has been overtaken, though narrowly: the ICT institute launched a platform for citizens to report personal-data breaches and misuse, with a published complaint-handling workflow, in January 2026, and the finance ministry and prosecutor-general agreed a confidential national line for reporting corruption in public procurement in November 2025. Both are single-purpose, neither is general redress, and the municipal development programme's own grievance portal states on its page that it is offline and read-only.

The programme paying for much of this is behind. The World Bank's Digital Acceleration Project had disbursed 41.67% of a revised US$201.31 million envelope — US$83.88 million — by 31 March 2026, with implementation progress upgraded from moderately unsatisfactory to moderately satisfactory. The forward ambition keeps arriving as strategy: the intellectual property strategy for 2026–2035 targets digitalising the whole administration of IP rights. The digital transformation agency held its first digital service delivery design lab with the World Bank, bringing public bodies together to pick priority services and map user journeys, reported in October 2026.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Even in the capital the municipal finance systems do not add up to one system: as at September 2020 Maputo ran property tax on SISPGIA, economic-activity fees on SISTAE, revenue collection and management on SIRR and SIGERE, the budget on M17 and solid-waste management on SGRSU. Of the registers local administration depends on, the national postal addressing code was piloted by the regulator INCM in Manhiça in 2020, with six cities planned over five years. No provincial or district administration was connected to a national data exchange, and no sub-national service portal was in operation, as at August 2026.

Rural digital data capture

Digital capture at the point of service is still the exception. As at 2024 the revised Civil Registration Code had established the electronic civil registration system e-SiRCEV as integrated with the national identity and health systems, and the education data system still ran on physical questionnaires in 2025. The exceptions are small, recent and donor-built: a pilot begun in 2024 lets hospital staff send a birth straight into the civil registry, starting in five districts of Inhambane, and one district of Zambézia has taken its education data system down to school level since mid-2024.

The connectivity underneath is being procured rather than delivered. INCM put a 30-site rural connectivity project out to tender in August 2025 and by October 2025 had awarded Vodacom a 60-station build across nine provinces; the World Bank's digital acceleration project carries a rural tower component that was to go to tender in mid-2025,

and a separate operation runs last-mile rural broadband on the same infrastructure as rural electrification. Power is the harder constraint, rural electricity access standing at a small fraction of the urban rate in 2022. The agriculture ministry said in December 2025 that it was designing a single portal for producer and plot registration, certification and traceability, though most rural land was unregistered in 2021 and carries no title for such a record to attach to.

Technology

AI

A National Commission for Artificial Intelligence, created by a decree in force since April 2026, began advising government in May 2026 on regulation, education, research, cybersecurity and the labour-market effects of the technology — while the strategy it will have to clear is still a draft. INTIC put a first National Artificial Intelligence Strategy out for public consultation between 4 May and 4 June 2026, and the text must pass a multisectoral working group convened by the communications minister, then the commission, then the Council of Ministers.

The draft, covering 2026–2031, rests on five founding principles — ethics and human rights, transparency and accountability, technological security, digital inclusion, and data sovereignty, organised into eight sectoral pillars from innovation and infrastructure to energy and environmental impact, with objectives sequenced from reliable data and institutional capacity in the short term to sectoral interoperability and digital governance in the medium term. It cites UNESCO's ethics recommendation, the OECD AI Principles and the EU AI Act among the instruments shaping AI governance. The work is backed by UNESCO, the ITU, the EU, the African Union and the World Bank.

There is no AI law, and the World Bank's December 2025 data-governance diagnostic records that preparing one is not a priority given more pressing gaps in the legal framework for data. The nearest binding text is the National Payments System law passed in principle in April 2026, which the government said would set security measures for the use of technology and artificial intelligence. Inside government, what exists is training rather than systems: the National Elections Commission's 2027 plan includes training staff in the use of AI for electoral communication and relaunching a rapid-response programme against election rumours.

A law regulating artificial intelligence in education is being drafted, and the minister said it would reach the Council of Ministers before the end of 2026; no text is published. Separately, an artificial-intelligence association launched in Maputo on 26 August 2026, presented by INTIC as a platform joining government, academia, the private sector and civil society.

Communications and digital transformation minister Américo Muchanga conceded in late July 2026 that national compute cannot support more advanced models, then told an investors' forum in Dar es Salaam in early August that Mozambique should become Southern Africa's AI hub. INTIC's own AI study (May 2025) records recommendations for government data-centre bandwidth to be raised, high-performance computing and model-training platforms to be acquired, a data-governance structure to be built and AI algorithms to be audited.

ICT Industry

Mozambique's formal technology sector is small enough to count one firm at a time: the startups a commercial tracker lists (2025) run to single figures, in an economy where the overwhelming majority of enterprises, and the great bulk of the labour force, operate informally. The labour market those firms hire into is Mozambique's second worst-scoring measure in the Ibrahim Index, 13.8 out of 100 for secure employment (2023), 49th of 54 African states and down 2.9 points over the decade.

The largest firm in the sector is the state's, and it is looking for a partner: Tmcel ended 2025 with 1.79 million mobile customers and fixed lines down 20 per cent to 15,537, as the government opened the selection of a strategic investor for part of its shareholding.

Innovation ecosystem

Dealroom recorded no disclosed venture capital investment in Mozambique over the trailing twelve months (2025), across nine tracked startups with a combined enterprise value of USD 20 million, ranking the country 36th among the African markets tracked. Mozambique places 128th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, in the bottom quartile of the economies ranked.

Routes in for a new entrant are few. Three hubs and incubators are listed in AfriLabs' member directory (2025) — Iniciativa para Democracia e Cidadania, ideiaLab Mozambique and Ideario Hub. The universal-access fund's regulation reserves a small share of its spending for innovation. The data centre inaugurated at Universidade Eduardo Mondlane in August 2026 is meant to open its capacity to start-ups and small technology firms as well as students and researchers.

Capacity

Literacy

Mozambique has the teachers and not the results. Human Resources in Education is one of the country's ten best-scoring indicators at 87.9 out of 100, 21st of 54 African states and up 6.7 points over the decade (2023), while over the same period Education Quality fell 3.2 points to 28.0, 41st of 54, even as the Education sub-category as a whole rose 5.6 points to 52.0, 27th of 54 (2023).

The pipeline narrows sharply above school level. Gross tertiary enrolment is 7.3%, and science and engineering graduates are 9.6% of all graduates, ranking Mozambique 111th of 133 economies (2024).

The digital measures aimed at schools do not reach learning outcomes. The 5G licences awarded in June 2026 oblige operators to connect schools and community institutions with equipment, installation and support included, and the education ministry's Education Technology Plan sets out interoperability between its own systems and the rest of government, with student records eventually keyed to the citizen identification number. Both are about what will be connected rather than who will be able to use it.

For adults outside school the first instrument is a memorandum: INTIC and a rural mobile-multimedia firm agreed on 21 September 2026 to run awareness campaigns, workshops and community forums on digital culture, cybersecurity and data protection, in Portuguese and where possible local languages, with no budget, reach target or start date stated. Civil servants are better served: 7,033 had been trained in digital skills by November 2025, on the government's count.

Training and skills

Cybersecurity is where the state's own training has gone furthest and is counted: the World Bank-funded PADIM project has run 14 training actions for 30 INTIC technicians and trained 2,032 professionals in cybersecurity (July 2026), alongside the SIM3 certifications held individually by Mozambican specialists, the instrument by which a response team's readiness is assessed.

Underneath that specialism the provision is broad and shallow. Mozambique has both a digital skills strategy and a digital skills training programme for civil servants, pitched at basic digital skills (2025), and 56 higher education institutions at the end of 2023, Eduardo Mondlane University the oldest and largest of them. The curriculum work

that would widen that base is externally financed: the ITU is running the regulatory and policy component of the EU-funded VaMoz Digital! programme over 2023–2027, which covers a digital skills curriculum and institutional capacity development for telecom regulators.

Where the people trained then go is thinner ground. A public job portal is in use for registration, vacancy search and applications, and for public-sector recruitment (2025), and MozDevz, a Mozambican community, trains young people in ICT and STEM.

The newest training demand is coming from inside institutions rather than from any national programme. Escola Superior de Jornalismo and Universidade Politécnica are responding to student and staff use of AI by revising curricula, training staff and drafting responsible-use rules rather than banning the technology, both holding that AI is in Mozambican universities to stay (August 2026). The National Elections Commission's 2027 plan likewise carries staff training in the use of AI for electoral communication.

Research institutions

Universidade Eduardo Mondlane's new data centre is meant to serve more than the university that built it: the centre is tied to the university's ICT master plan for 2026–2029, with private-cloud services and access for students, researchers, start-ups and small technology firms named as intended uses (August 2026).

The connectivity that would carry that beyond one campus is funded from outside the sector, through the Mozambique Digital Acceleration Project's allocation to MoRENet backbone and last-mile bandwidth for universities and TVET institutions (June 2025). The higher-education sector it would connect counted 56 institutions at the end of 2023, with Eduardo Mondlane the oldest and largest.

Inclusion

Access to services

Mozambique's flagship social transfer programme, the PSSB, reached 709,028 beneficiaries by the end of 2024 against a target of 1,199,573, or 59 per cent of the goal, on a Centre for Public Integrity assessment.

What usually stands between a person and a service is a document. First-time identity cards have been free of charge nationwide since November 2023, a waiver since extended to 2027 and widened from the identity card to the birth certificate and the cédula pessoal, and a free birth-registration campaign runs to the end of December 2026 against what the government itself calls a critical registration deficit that still leaves most children under five unregistered. The same absence of paper affects property, where most land held under customary or good-faith occupation carries no formal registration. For non-nationals the barrier is written into the rules: no framework gives refugees, asylum seekers or migrants an explicit right to open a digital payment account, and standard know-your-customer checks require a national identity document or a passport, while the central bank has allowed social-protection beneficiary cards to stand as an alternative identity document for opening one.

The online channel does not yet close the loop. The national public service portal is informational, so citizens can read about services but cannot transact through it, which makes the tax authority's issue of online-requested tax clearance certificates from 3 August 2026 an exception rather than the pattern, and government-to-person disbursement over the national switch a planned phase rather than a live national service.

Complaint channels are built sector by sector: a toll-free line for complaints about public administration opened in June 2021, and the water regulator takes complaints and appeals online through its RECO platform (June 2026).

Physical reach has moved faster than transactional depth: financial access points rose 47.0 per cent between December 2024 and May 2026, driven by a 54.0 per cent increase in e-money agents. Price is regulated only at the margin, article 23 of the universal-access fund regulation making a tariff 20 per cent below the normal one mandatory on universal-access services, and the June 2026 5G licences oblige operators to connect at least 3,000 schools and 1,000 community institutions including health centres, with equipment, installation and support included.

Digital divides

Mozambique's June 2026 5G licence awards carry an obligation to supply 710,000 subsidised smartphones — 420,000 4G and 290,000 5G handsets — to low-income users, small firms and students on instalment terms, placing the constraint on the device rather than the network. Internet access stood below a quarter of the population when the Internet for All project launched in December 2024, and only a minority of the population holds a smartphone. The distance between availability and use is the sharper of the two gaps: mobile networks now reach most of the country's localities, while internet access, cost and computer availability together remain one of Mozambique's ten worst-scoring governance indicators.

Where the divide has been measured by sex, GSMA found around 9 per cent of women in Mozambique using mobile internet in 2018 against 22 per cent of men, alongside a mobile phone ownership gap of about 24 per cent, then the third largest among the African markets it surveyed.

The money set against all this is capped rather than open-ended: article 14 of the 2025 universal-access fund regulation reserves up to 14 per cent of FSAU spending for digital inclusion aimed at vulnerable groups and 3 per cent for innovation, against 55 per cent for its principal category. Concessional money has moved the other way, the mid-2025 review of the World Bank digital acceleration project having proposed cutting its digital inclusion allocation to pay for rural connectivity. Exclusion also has a financial and physical geography: twenty-six regions of the country had no bank branch (2025), and rural households had a small fraction of urban electricity access in 2022.

Data

National statistics

No labour force survey had been run in Mozambique in the ten years to 2023, on the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators, which leaves employment — and with it every question about who works in the digital economy — with no recent national instrument behind it. The gap is specific rather than a survey programme in collapse: the same indicators record three or more health surveys, two household surveys and two agricultural surveys over those ten years, and a population census and a business census both fall inside the same window, though the agricultural census does not.

The imbalance runs through the index's five pillars: Mozambique scores 70-89 per cent on data use and on data products, 50-69 per cent on data services and data infrastructure, and only 20-49 per cent on data sources, the weakest of the five (2023) — better at publishing and using statistics than at collecting them.

The statistical system's own capacity has been climbing: the Ibrahim Index rates Capacity of the Statistical System at 53.0 out of 100, 23rd of 54 African states and up 8.7 points over the decade (2023). Sector series run ahead of that average: INCM publishes an annual communications regulation report whose 2024 edition carries per-operator coverage gaps and provincial subscriber breakdowns.

Administrative data is not yet a substitute. Government data management practices are fragmented (2025), and the arrangements for governing that data are only planned or in progress, with the responsible function sitting inside another institution rather than in a body of its own (2025). The World Bank's December 2025 diagnostic recommends an inventory of the data held across government, with INAGE to lead a common data exchange infrastructure. The registers that would have to carry the load have their own gaps, in birth registration and in business registration, and around 80% of the labour force and around 90% of enterprises operate informally (2024), which is much of why what the state needs to count is not in the records it keeps.

Open data

Mozambique has no open government data portal (2025). The right to ask for what is not published exists — Law No. 34/2014 grants it and gives the authorities a maximum of twenty-one days to answer.

Neither route is improving. Accessibility of Public Records stands at 20.6 out of 100, 38th of 54 African states, down 2.7 points over the decade and among Mozambique's ten worst-scoring indicators of 96; Disclosure of Public Records, which measures what the state publishes of its own accord, is 30.7, 33rd of 54 and down 0.3 points over the same ten years (2023).

Across the 23 data categories Open Data Watch assessed for Mozambique in 2024, the average score is 4.5 out of 10, and 14 of the 23 score 5.0 or below.

The weakness is not evenly spread. Education outcomes reach 7 out of 10 and balance of payments 6.5, while poverty scores 3.0 and national accounts, agriculture and crime 3.5 each (2024) — the domains that settle arguments about who is poor and what the economy is doing are the ones least available. Individual institutions do better than the centre: the Banco de Moçambique publishes national payment system statistics on a fixed schedule, and the e-procurement system publishes tender notices and awarded contracts (2025).

What stays unpublished is more often the instrument than the statistic. The rules of the national instant payment scheme are available only to its participants (2025), and the data sharing agreement attached to Mozambique's health memorandum with the United States is among the documents a Washington court was asked in April 2026 to compel the State Department to release. A national data governance policy reached a second zero draft in November 2025.

Use of satellite data

Mozambique now holds a standing aerial mapping capability of its own. A development-bank and Korean-financed programme left nine LiDAR-equipped drone systems, simulators, unmanned surface vessels and data platforms, and certified 30 specialists in July 2026 from the meteorology institute, the disaster management institute, the cartography and remote-sensing centre, the roads administration and the water directorate; the cohort was deployed half-trained into the January 2026 Marracuene floods, which the district recorded with no loss of life. Weather warning is the established use: the meteorology institute's system runs on satellite, radar and surface data relayed by SMS and community radio, and WMO credits it with holding Cyclone Freddy's 2023 toll under 200. That account is the financing bank's own, and it names no custodian institution, running cost or arrangement for sharing the mapping output. The other use of satellite capacity is a communications one: SpaceX donated Starlink terminals that INCM deployed at accommodation and coordination centres in flood-affected areas in February 2026, giving emergency low-earth-orbit connectivity where the terrestrial network had gone. The state operator began proof-of-concept testing of Angola's ANGOSAT-2 satellite for telecommunications services in August 2026, under a bilateral memorandum signed that June. No national space or geospatial data policy had been adopted as at August 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The health memorandum the United States and Mozambique signed on 15 December 2025 penalises failure on a Data Sharing Agreement executed the same day, attaches neither that agreement nor the Specimen Sharing Agreement beside it, and carries no personal-data, data-ownership, hosting or residency clause anywhere in its text.

Nine months on, the terms of that data agreement remain outside public view. The State Department put a subset of the health memoranda on its website in March 2026, then removed public access, and has published none of the related agreements, including Mozambique's; it refused a public-interest fee waiver and had reached no final determination by 2 April 2026, when Public Citizen sued in the District of Columbia. Mozambique is one of sixteen countries named in that case, whose freedom-of-information request expressly seeks the data sharing agreement.

The memorandum is also where most of the American footprint sits, because it is the instrument behind the planned United States funding of Mozambique's health data systems through to 2030 and the systems that money is meant to build — a national health data exchange and data warehouse, and the SIS-RME electronic medical record that is to absorb the US-built SESP patient tracking system, due to pass to Mozambican management by 20 June 2026.

Everything else is small or unformed. The Ministry of Economy's approach to SpaceX on connectivity and digital infrastructure was still exploratory as at July 2026, with nothing signed, and the other recorded American contribution is USAID's donation of computers to the Attorney General's Office for its digitalisation in 2024.

China activities

Mozambique became a founding signatory of the World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization in Shanghai on 16 July 2026, one of 29 founding states and one of ten African ones, joining a Chinese-convened body at its creation while its own AI strategy was still in draft. At the high-level governance meeting that followed on 17–20 July, Xi Jinping attacked the use of national-security arguments to restrict technology transfer and pledged 5,000 AI training places over five years, international cooperation centres and AI meteorological systems for around 30 countries. Three months earlier the digital transformation agency had signed a memorandum with Huawei on public-sector AI, Portuguese-language models, data centres and cloud, and training about 5,000 technicians over three years, with no value or data terms published.

The substantive Chinese position, though, is in the state operator's network rather than in AI diplomacy. China Eximbank financed a concessional loan to Tmcel for the first phase of modernising and expanding the national mobile network in 2020, and Tmcel has since secured a second Eximbank facility for a further phase, reported as being on "very good terms" (2025). Chinese-affiliated hosting has arrived separately and commercially, with Alibaba Cloud's Africa local public cloud service running from a Maputo data centre (2024) under BCX rather than under any state agreement.

China Eximbank is the second-largest external financier of Mozambique's recorded digital commitments, behind the World Bank, and both of its loans go to the same borrower, Tmcel.

EU activities

European money in Mozambique's digital estate is grant money on long timetables rather than lending, and the largest of it is VaMOZ Digital!, a EUR 22.5 million grant (about US$24 million) running from 2022 to 2029. The European Union added a further digital transformation allocation under Global Gateway, signed in June 2026 with a stated focus on women's participation in the digital economy.

European influence on the rulebook runs ahead of European spending. ENIA Draft 1 takes the EU AI Act as one of its explicit reference instruments, alongside UNESCO's Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence and the OECD AI Principles, and the European Union is among the backers of the strategy's development, with UNESCO, the ITU, the African Union, the World Bank, German Cooperation, IRCAI and the UN University's policy and e-governance unit (May 2026). On the commercial side, Vodacom's group chief executive met President Chapo in Maputo to discuss connectivity, fibre expansion, AI adoption and digital inclusion (July 2026), with no amount, agreement or timeline announced.

The European Union holds three of the recorded external digital commitments, but a smaller recorded value than either the World Bank or China Eximbank.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf party is recorded as financing, building or operating any part of Mozambique's digital estate as at August 2026.

India activities

No Indian party is recorded as financing, building or operating any part of Mozambique's digital estate as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Mozambique's digital transformation agency has put a government data centre and a sovereign cloud among the priorities of its 2026–2029 operational plan: ATDI set them among the plan's bases in September 2026 to secure government information, and the state administration minister told the digital-transformation commission on 21 September 2026 that data produced by the public administration must belong to the State.

The rules in force are sectoral. Decree 71/2025, the data-centre regulation, carries provisions on data centres located abroad and on storing information classified as a state secret, and Banco de Moçambique's Aviso 6/GBM/2026, gazetted on 31 August 2026, requires every bank and financial company to keep its primary data centre and principal information systems in Mozambique, with secondary centres abroad only on the central bank's authorisation and globally operated systems exempt on notice. INTIC's November 2025 zero draft of a data governance policy would classify government data in four tiers, up to secret or classified.

Part of the hosting is already the state's own. CEDSIF, the finance ministry's systems centre, runs a secondary data centre for the state's critical financial information systems, and tendered for its backup power in July 2026, and the e-government institute INAGE built CloudGov, a file-storage and sharing system for public institutions, in 2020. The identity and travel-document system runs under an eight-year concession awarded to Muhlbauer in 2018. Whether the state holds the source code for that system, or can exit the concession, was not on record as at September 2026. The terms on which the concession and the data-sharing agreement signed with the United States in December 2025 govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The trust layer has a public partner: INTIC signed a memorandum with Brazil's National Institute of Information Technology in February 2026 on accreditation, audit and training for operating a Mozambican root certification authority. For AI, the communications minister conceded in July 2026 that national compute cannot support more advanced models. Regionally, Mozambique's customs administration adopted a customs-to-customs data-exchange roadmap with four SADC neighbours in August 2026.

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